

Summary

This chapter's project was a program that produces recursive Droste effect images, just like the illustration on old tins of Droste's Cacao. The program works by using pure magenta pixels with RGB values of (255, 0, 255) to mark the parts of the image that should be replaced by a smaller version. Since this smaller version will also have its own smaller magenta area, the replacements will repeat until the magenta area is gone to produce a recursive image.

The base case for our recursive algorithm occurs when no more magenta pixels remain in the image to place the smaller recursive image in, or when the `stopAfter` counter reaches 0. Otherwise, the recursive case passes the image to the `makeDroste()` function to continue to replace the magenta area with even smaller recursive images.

You can modify your own photos to add magenta pixels and then run them through the Droste Maker. The museum patron looking at an exhibit of themselves, the cat in front of a computer monitor of the cat in front of a computer monitor, and the faceless *Mona Lisa* images are just a few examples of the surreal possibilities you can create with this recursive program.